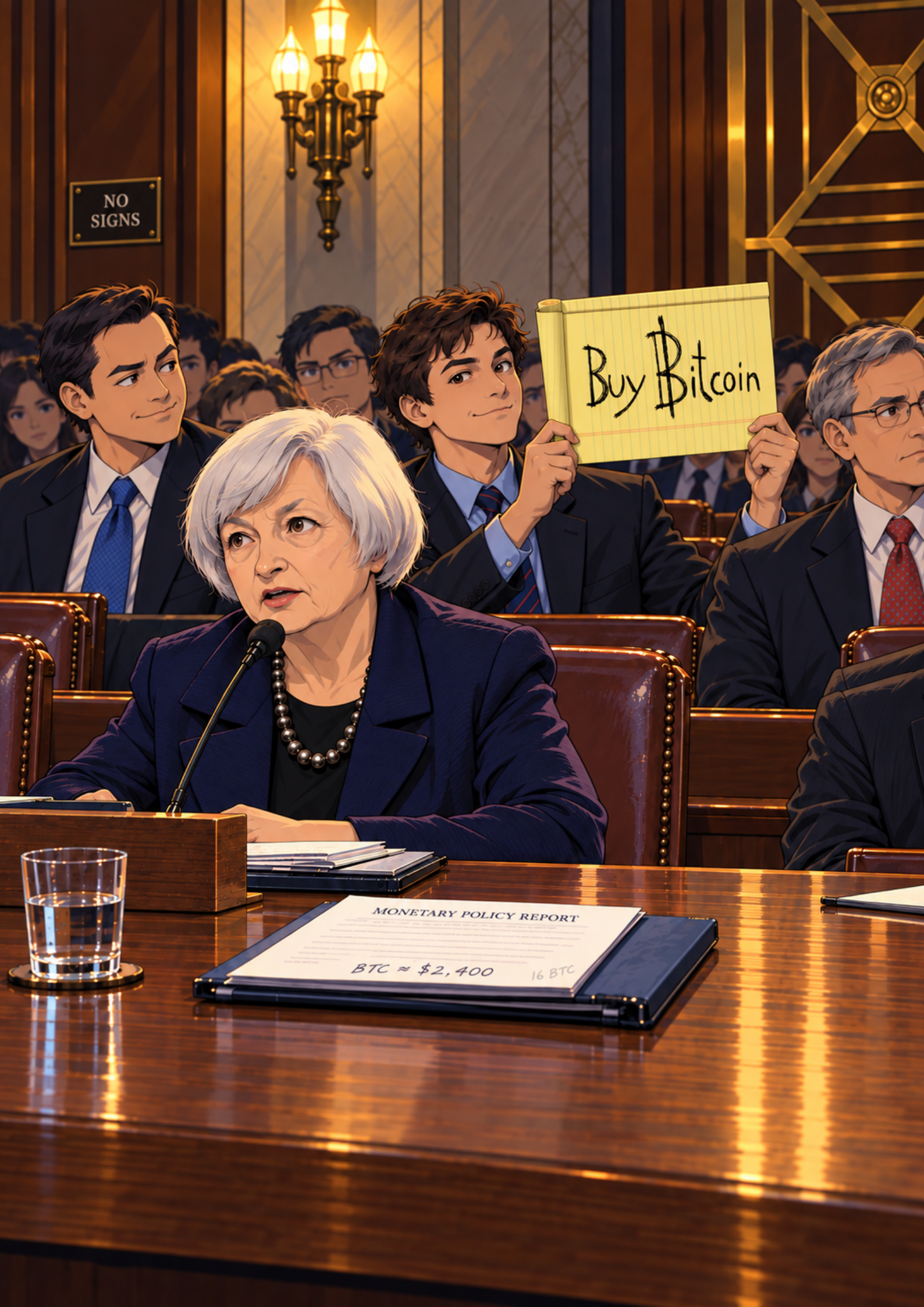




NO
SIGNS

Buy Bitcoin

MONETARY POLICY REPORT

BTC ≈ \$2,400 16 BTC

BEHIND THE CHAIR

039 / 12 JUL 2017 / BITCOIN / COMMON

BUY BITCOIN.

On 12 July 2017, Federal Reserve Chair Janet Yellen appeared before the House Financial Services Committee in Washington, D.C., to deliver her semiannual monetary-policy testimony.

Employment, inflation and interest rates were on the agenda. Behind her, a young man raised a yellow legal pad with two handwritten words: "Buy Bitcoin."

The sign-holder was Christian Langalis, later known as Bitcoin Sign Guy. His brief appearance in the television frame turned an audience seat into an improvised broadcast position. No elaborate production was needed: ink, paper and a place behind the witness put the message alongside one of the most recognisable figures in central banking.

The image's humour comes from that arrangement. Yellen faces the committee while the sign competes for the viewer's attention just behind her shoulder. The formal business continues in the foreground; a spectator supplies his own message in the background. A physical sheet of paper gives a digital currency a simple, portable image that can travel far beyond the room.

The paper later became a collectible in its own right. Scarce City's auction of the original sign recorded a winning bid of 16 BTC on 24 April 2024. That later event gives the scene a second timescale: a moment caught on television in 2017, and an object preserved and valued years afterward.

The artwork holds those times together without pretending to be a photograph. The report heading anchors the congressional setting, while the small price note and 16 BTC annotation add illustrative context. The wall plaque supplies a visual joke. The date belongs to the House appearance; Yellen submitted identical remarks to a Senate committee the following day.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE HANDWRITTEN SIGN

The yellow legal pad carries the moment's two-word message. Its ordinary paper and improvised lettering are central to the real stunt, bringing a personal appeal into a televised policy hearing.

02 THE NO SIGNS PLAQUE

This invented wall fixture makes the raised sign a visual joke about the room's rules. It is illustrative staging, not a claim that this plaque hung at the hearing.

03 THE REPORT HEADING

MONETARY POLICY REPORT identifies the business of Yellen's appearance. The drawn document is a contextual prop, not a facsimile of her papers or evidence that she wrote the annotations.

04 THE ROUNDED PRICE NOTE

BTC approximately \$2,400 evokes a reported price that afternoon. The amount is rounded for the illustration and does not establish Bitcoin's price at the instant the sign appeared.

05 THE 16 BTC FLASHFORWARD

This small annotation points to the original sign's 2024 winning auction bid. It deliberately reaches forward seven years; it is not a note made at the 2017 hearing.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: [Federal Reserve testimony](#); [Scarce City auction and reproduced coverage](#). The auction page reproduces CNBC's 12 July report of \$2,418.46 at 2:27 p.m. ET; the painted amount is an approximate afternoon reference. The annotations and NO SIGNS plaque are artistic inventions, not Yellen's notes or a documented wall fixture. BUY BITCOIN. uses the sign's words with normalised capitals and punctuation, not investment advice. Incidental attendees remain unidentified. No cross-card cameo, affiliation, endorsement or rights clearance is implied.